

O Lord, How Shall I Meet Thee

- 1 O Lord, how shall I meet thee,
how welcome thee aright?
Thy people long to greet thee,
my hope, my heart's delight!
O kindle, Lord Most Holy,
thy lamp within my breast
to do in spirit lowly
all that may please thee best.
- 2 Love caused thy incarnation,
love brought thee down to me;
thy thirst for my salvation
procured my liberty.
O love beyond all telling,
that led thee to embrace,
in love all love excelling,
our lost and fallen race!
- 3 Rejoice, then, thou sad hearted,
who sit in deepest gloom,
who mourn o'er joys departed
and tremble at thy doom.
Despair not, he is near thee,
yea, standing at the door,
who best can help and cheer thee
and bids thee weep no more.
- 4 Sin's debt, that fearful burden,
let not thy souls distress;
thy guilt the Lord will pardon
and cover by his grace.
He comes, for men procuring
the peace of sin forgiv'n,
for all God's sons securing
their heritage in heav'n.

Words: Paul Gerhardt, 1653; tr. Catherine Winkworth, 1863; alt.

Music: Melchior Teschner, ca. 1615

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